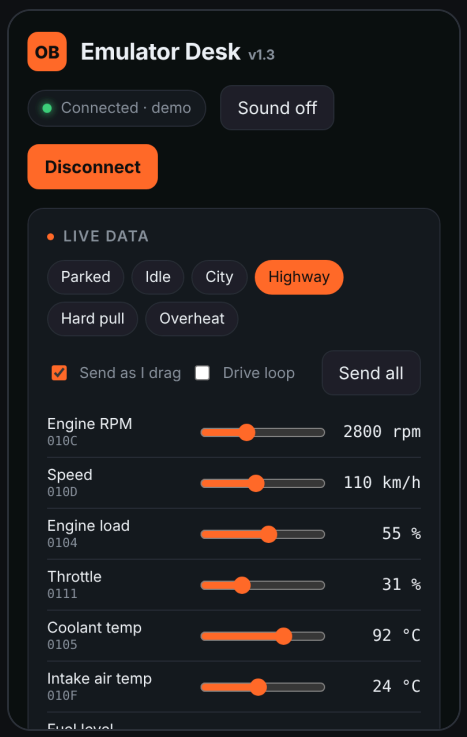
Emulator Desk

A Mac control panel for the Freematics OBD-II Emulator MK2

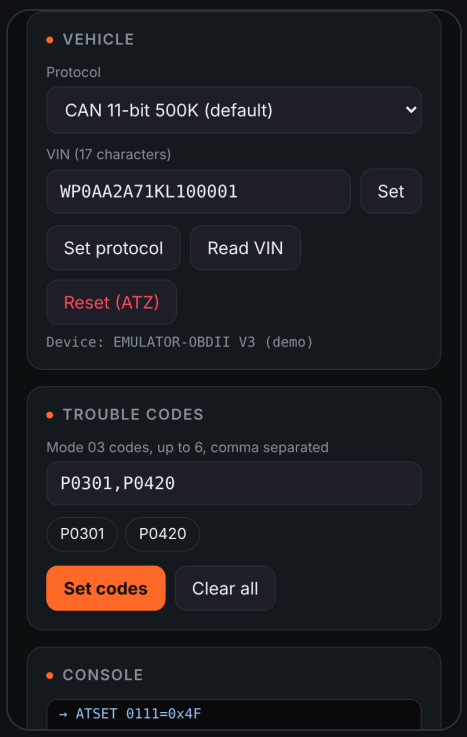
App **v1.3**
Document **v1.3**

Emulator Desk drives a Freematics MK2 emulator from Google Chrome over its USB cable, so a Mac can do what the Windows-only Freematics GUI does. You set live engine values, the VIN, the bus protocol and trouble codes, and any OBD-II dongle or scan tool plugged into the emulator reads them as if it were in a real car. It runs from a web page, with nothing to install.



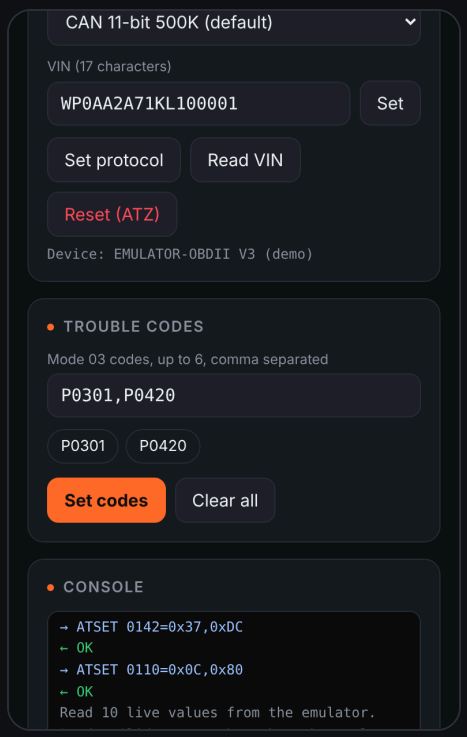
Live data

Ten sliders for the common Mode 01 values, with presets from Parked to Overheat. Values go out as you drag.



Vehicle and codes

Pick the protocol, set or read back the VIN, and load up to six Mode 03 trouble codes. Clear them in one tap.



Console

Every command and reply is logged. Type any AT command by hand when you need something the panel doesn't cover.

10
live PIDs with sliders

6
driving presets plus a drive loop

7
bus protocols to choose from

1
link to open it, nothing to install

LIVE DATA

Ten common values, sent as the raw bytes the OBD-II standard uses. Drive loop cycles pulling away, cruising and braking every few seconds so a dongle sees a moving car.

DONGLE OVER BLUETOOTH

Connect a Bluetooth LE ELM327 dongle that's plugged into the emulator, and the app reads RPM, speed and coolant from it next to what the emulator serves. Green dots mean they match.

GOOD TO KNOW

On connect the sliders read back what the emulator is serving. Reset (ATZ) restarts it in a few seconds and zeroes every value. Its EMULATOR-OBDII V3 firmware can set the VIN but not read it back, and it can't tell whether a dongle is plugged in.

ENGINE SOUND

Turn on Sound and a synthesized flat-six revs with the RPM slider, getting louder and brighter as throttle opens. It follows presets and the drive loop too.

Technical setup

Sources, integrations and what runs where

App **v1.3**
Document **v1.3**

SOURCES AND LIBRARIES

Piece	Version	What it does	Loaded from	Licence
Emulator Desk	1.3	The whole app: UI, command queue, PID encoding, presets, drive loop, engine sound, dongle check	`index.html` on GitHub Pages	Written for this app
Freematics AT command set	EMULATOR-OBDII V3 (tested)	Commands the app sends: `ATE0`, `ATZ`, `ATSET`, `ATGET` (PIDs), `ATCLR DTC`	Built into the emulator	Freematics
OBD-II PID formulas	SAE J1979	Byte encodings for each slider (e.g. RPM × 4 as two bytes, temperature + 40)	Hard-coded in the app	Public standard
System fonts	n/a	SF Pro and SF Mono on Mac, Arial and Consolas elsewhere	The operating system	OS fonts

No third-party libraries, CDNs or web fonts are used.

INTEGRATIONS

Integration	Used for	Details
Web Serial API	Talking to the emulator	`navigator.serial.requestPort()`, opened at 38400 baud, 8N1. Commands end in `\r`. You pick the port in Chrome's chooser; no auth. Works in Chrome and Edge, not Safari or Firefox.
Freematics OBD-II Emulator MK2	The device being controlled	USB to serial through a CP2102 (newer units, `/dev/cu.usbserial-*`) or CH340 bridge, both with drivers built into macOS. Needs its 12V adapter for power. The app labels the chip from the USB vendor ID.
Web Bluetooth	Reading a plugged-in dongle	`navigator.bluetooth.requestDevice()`, you pick the dongle. Finds a notify and a write characteristic (FFE0, FFF0, 18F0 and similar), sends ELM327 commands (`ATZ`, `ATSP0`, `010C`, `010D`, `0105`). Locked dongles such as Automatic's don't answer.
Web Audio API	Engine sound	Three oscillators at the flat-six firing rate (RPM ÷ 60 × 3) plus filtered noise, through a waveshaper, low-pass filter and compressor. Starts only when you press Sound.
GitHub Pages	Hosting	`davidanthonyalleyne-dot.github.io/emulator-desk`, served from the `main` branch of the public `emulator-desk` repo. Static files only.

WHAT RUNS WHERE

On your Mac: everything. The page runs in Chrome and sends one command at a time, waiting up to 1.2 seconds for OK or ERROR before the next.

Network: one page load from GitHub Pages. After that the app makes no web requests.

Data kept: nothing. Slider values, VIN and codes live only in the open page and on the emulator itself.

Demo mode: add `?demo` to the address to try the app without hardware. The screenshots in this document use it with sample values.

REGENERATING THIS DOCUMENT

In `docs/overview`, run `node shoot.js` to retake the screenshots in demo mode at 390 × 844, then `node pdf.js` to print `overview.pdf` on Letter pages.